

Vulnerability Report

TamperedChef - A High-Severity Multi-Stage Infostealer Operation

TamperedChef is a sophisticated 2025 malware campaign distributing signed fake PDF tools through SEO-driven malvertising. The malware features a unique 56-day dormancy period, functioning normally before mass activation on August 21, 2025, deploying an obfuscated backdoor for credential theft, data exfiltration, and remote access.

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Risks :

1. Credential Theft and Browser Data Exfiltration
2. Persistent Remote Access and Control
3. Potential Ransomware Deployment and Initial Access Brokerage

Affected Platform :

- Microsoft Windows

Malware :

- CWE-78 (Improper Neutralization of Special Elements in OS Commands)

Major Countries Impacted :

- United States (80% of victims), with smaller impact across Europe

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Top 3 Recommendations :

1. Hunt and Remediate :

Search for persistence indicators (registry keys, scheduled tasks) and perform immediate credential resets with full system reimaging for confirmed infections

2. Implement Behavioral Detection :

Deploy EDR tuned for suspicious patterns like browser process termination by non-browser apps and JavaScript execution from AppData folders

3. Control Software Installation :

Enforce strict application control policies, block malicious C2 infrastructure, and educate users about malvertising risks

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